



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Bastrop
School Website: <https://wwwFOUNDERSBASTROP.COM/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy Bastrop (TX 78602) presents a clearly classical-oriented mission and program, centering on virtue, truth, beauty, and a liberal-arts orientation. Public-facing materials emphasize a classical approach, a focus on formation (virtue, character, wisdom), and a partnership orientation with families. However, the visible pedagogy and some curricular specifics do not uniformly align with the fullest classical model (notably, the site lacks explicit references to Great Books, Socratic seminars in the upper grades, and a "living curriculum" / teacher-as-mentor ethos in the public materials). On balance, the school sits between Classical and Somewhat Classical, with several core elements well-supported but with notable gaps in pedagogy, faculty modeling, and explicit curricular attributes standard to a fully classical program.

Overall rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Key insights:

- Positive anchors: explicit liberal-arts framing; mission to form virtuous citizens; emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty; clear partnership language with families; commitments to character formation and Wisdom.
- Evidence: "We utilize a classical approach to education characterized by a traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum and whole-group teaching methodology with an orientation towards truth, beauty, and goodness" and "the end (goal) of public education in America is to form responsible citizens and virtuous people" ; ;
- Gaps to reach full classic status: absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis; limited public articulation of Socratic pedagogy or scholé; pedagogy described as "whole-group" rather than explicitly Socratic or dialectical in the public materials; limited public statements about a teacher-as-living-curriculum or strong faculty formation culture.
- Evidence of gap: no explicit Great Books or Great Conversation claims in the public content; pedagogy described as "whole-group teaching methodology" rather than Socratic seminars in the available materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize orientation toward truth, beauty, and goodness as core ideals of a classical education, and a formation/virtue emphasis in public statements about the school's goals (virtue, character). Examples include: "a traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum and whole-group teaching methodology with an orientation towards truth, beauty, and goodness" and statements about forming virtuous citizens ; .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue.

- Negative keywords present: none evident in the public content (no explicit counter-messages around relativism or secularism in the provided materials).
- Grounded lexicon reference: Positive keyword lists include truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; and related transcendental terms. The school's materials prominently include truth, goodness, beauty, and virtue.
- Why this rating
- The school foregrounds transcendental moral ideals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue, aligning with Transcendental moral realism and a formation-oriented view, but there is no explicit theology or liturgical practice described in the public-facing materials. That combination supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than full CLASSICAL, given the absence of explicit theological grounding and liturgical practices in the accessible content.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school explicitly frames education as formation toward virtuous citizens and human flourishing, with a stated orientation toward truth, goodness, and beauty; a core aim of forming character rather than merely providing information. The Educational Imperative states the goal of forming virtuous citizens and the belief that classical schools should promote these ends on a national scale. ;
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, goodness, human flourishing, classical mission (as implied by “classical education”).
- Negative keywords present: none explicitly in the public content (no explicit emphasis on work-readiness or workforce metrics; the messaging centers on formation and virtue).
- Lexicon alignment: Positive keywords cover formation, teleology, pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful; and virtue. The school's materials consistently emphasize formation and virtue as telos.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated aims center on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful, which aligns strongly with classical aims for Curriculum and Purpose/Goal even though it stops short of some explicit Great-Books signaling in the public materials. Given the clear call to formation and virtue, CLASSICAL is warranted here.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The materials characterize a traditional liberal-arts and sciences curriculum (liberal arts orientation) as central. The explicit mention of “traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum” signals a classical structure, though public content does not repeatedly enumerate the Seven Liberal Arts or Great Books as core requirements.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, classical education, traditional curriculum (based on the phrasing of “traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum”).
- Negative keywords present: lack of explicit Great Books, lack of direct Great Conversation references; no explicit listing of the Seven Liberal Arts or Quadrivium in public-facing copy.
- Relevant lexicon signals: The “Seven Liberal Arts” and “Great Books/Great Conversation” are strong positive indicators in the classical lexicon, but not clearly evidenced on the Bastrop site content. See lexicon mappings and absence of explicit Great Books in public copy.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum is framed as liberal-arts oriented, which is a hallmark of classical education, but the public materials do not demonstrate full articulation of core classical curriculum elements (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin/Greek adoption). The absence of explicit Great Books and detailed classical curriculum components suggests SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public-facing materials describe a “whole-group teaching methodology,” which deviates from typical classical pedagogy that emphasizes Socratic discussion, memory work, recitation, and seminar-style formats in the upper grades. There is no explicit reference to Socratic seminars, scholé, or classical memory techniques in the accessible copy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: none of the classical pedagogy signals (e.g., Socratic seminars, recitation, chanting) are evidenced in the public materials.
- Negative keywords present: “Socratic dialogue,” “narration,” “recitation,” “chanting,” and “Scholé” are not described; “restful learning” is not described either. The lexicon would flag these as potential signals if present; their absence functions as a lack rather than a stated negative feature in the public copy. The known public pedagogy is “whole-group teaching.”
- Lexicon references: Pedagogy signals in the lexicon include Socratic seminar, narration, chanting, scholé, etc. This content is not visible in the Bastrop public copy.
- Why this rating
- The public articulation of pedagogy does not meet the hallmark signals of classical pedagogy (Socratic/dialectic, memory-based recitation, etc.). The available content describes a more conventional classroom approach, thus NOT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy per the public materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The available public content names a Headmaster and general staff but does not present a “living curriculum,” a portrait of teacher as mentor, or a faculty culture described as the core of the school (i.e., teacher-as-models of virtue; mentorship culture; collegial faculty community). The “faculty as living curriculum” language is not evidenced in public pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: “teacher as mentor,” “living curriculum,” and “portrait of a teacher” are not explicitly used on the Bastrop site; those are listed as positive signals in the classical lexicon/documents but are not evidenced. The site does reference teachers (e.g., Headmaster) but not a fully developed faculty-formation narrative.
- Negative keywords present: Not explicitly present in public copy; rather, absence of explicit “living curriculum” language is the signal.
- Lexicon alignment: The Six Essential Elements lists “The living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” as key signals of classical faculty; these are not publicly evidenced on the Bastrop site.
- Why this rating
- With only a basic staff mention and no explicit articulation of faculty as the living curriculum or exemplar teachers, the category does not meet the classical grade in its public materials. The absence of a clearly defined faculty-culture narrative leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy’s counterpart in the faculty category as described by the rubric.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school speaks of partnering with families and of education “in partnership with you” in the student’s education; public content emphasizes working with families, and enrollment/parent-communication channels are active, indicating a family-inclusive approach. The content demonstrates an orientation toward parent engagement and collaboration, which aligns with classical expectations for parental partnership (even if not always described with the full “co-teacher” language).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teaching language appears in the classical lexicon, and the school’s messaging includes partnering with families in the education of their scholars.

Positive keywords such as parent partnership, family involvement, parental engagement appear in the classical lexicon; the public copy uses “partnering with you.” See the lexicon and public copy.

- Negative keywords present: none explicit in public content; the site does not present a consumer-only model or minimal parent involvement.
- Why this rating
- The Bastrop site communicates engagement with families and a willingness to partner with parents (though not always in the exact “co-teacher” terminology). This aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals for Parents & Community rather than fully CLASSICAL (which would demand more explicit, formalized parent formation programs and a visible, intentional parent-education ecosystem). The presence of partnership language suffices to place this category at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school aimed to reach CLASSICAL in all six categories, concrete steps could include:
- Pedagogy (Element 4): Adopt and publicly articulate Socratic seminars and disciplined memory-work (recitation, chanting) in appropriate grade bands; incorporate Scholé-style contemplative days; specify how upper-grade seminars and rhetorical training will be delivered.
- Curriculum (Element 3): Explicitly adopt and publicize Great Books/Great Conversation components, including core primary sources and canonical literature; specify the Seven Liberal Arts and Quadrivium in curriculum structure where feasible; articulate cross-curricular integration with a clear plan for history across subjects and primary-source emphasis.
- Faculty (Element 5): Develop a formal “living curriculum” model where teachers embody and model classical virtues and intellectual habits; publish a faculty portrait/character profile; implement ongoing teacher formation around classical pedagogy and mentorship.
- Religious/Metaphysical Foundations (Element 1): If desired, deepen explicit theological or liturgical dimensions (where aligned with school mission and state policy) and describe liturgical or communal practices (even if nonsectarian) that nurture reverence, wonder, and moral formation without compromising compliance.
- Parents & Community (Element 6): Expand explicit parent formation offerings (book studies, lectures) and ensure transparent, regular opportunities for parents to observe and participate as co-educators; maintain open-campus days and formal parent-led groups with clear mission statements.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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